

Riley Yaxley

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Work History

Resource Development Manager, Nov. 2020 - Present

National Performance Network

- Develop organizational fundraising strategy and manage funder stewardship plan with program directors
- Project manage annual grant proposals and reports for NPN's 10-15 annual foundation partners using Asana
- Manage donor data, ensuring it is maintained and updated in Salesforce
- Participate in finance and communications board committees

Editor, Sept. 2022 - Present

Fundraising & Revenue Coordinator, Jan. 2024 - Present

Sixty Inches from Center

- Provide writers developmental and copy editing support for commissioned articles
- Develop and manage the fundraising initiatives and revenue-driven partnerships that support Sixty's projects, publishings, and operations

Fundraising & Grant Writing Consultant, Oct. 2022 - Present

Joan Mitchell Center

- Provide grant writing and fundraising professional development for resident artists through one-on-one consultations

Development Writer, June 2019 - Nov. 2020

Data Management Specialist, Dec. 2018 - June 2019

Art Institute of Chicago

- Wrote acknowledgement letters on behalf of the president and senior vice president
- Wrote and designed proposals and stewardship reports for major donors and museum trustees using InDesign
- Ensured efficient data entry and integrity in museum's Raiser's Edge database
- Led the museum's equity initiative as a working group co-chair, improving staff engagement and furthering diversity and inclusion efforts

Education

DePaul University

MA in Writing, Rhetoric, and Discourse, Nov. 2019

BA in Writing, Rhetoric, and Discourse, June 2018

- Recipient of Summer Undergraduate Research Grant, May 2017

School of the Art Institute of Chicago, Aug. - Dec. 2019

Graduate Continuing Studies

Residencies & Workshops

Gibraltar Point Centre for the Arts (January 2026)

Non-Conforming Criticism Lab (November 2025 - January 2026)

ACRE Residency (July 2025)

Tin House 2025 Winter Workshop (January 2025)

Muña Art Writing Residency (May-August 2023)

Volunteer Experience

Co-chair of Advancement, Jan. 2019 - June 2022

Intuit: The Center for Intuitive and Outsider Art's Young Professionals Board

- Led the planning of Spring Intuit, the museum's annual spring benefit
- Served ex-officio on the museum's board of trustee's development committee

Publications

Sixty Inches From Center

- A Sticky End, 2025
- A toxin threatens, but it also beckons, 2025
- The Risky Sex, or Why I'm Befriending Men, 2025
- Your Portrait, My Love, 2025
- I am whispering to you, 2025
- Fucking Like a Girl, 2025
- Quicker Than a Ray of Light, Then Gone, 2024
- A Miserable Party, March 2024
- Consider a Disappearance, March 2024
- An Angel with Her Wings, December 2023
- CELESTE WILL ALWAYS BE THE ALT GIRL, October 2023
- The Tongue, September 2023
- Too Much Sentimentality, May 2023
- The Lovers, December 2022
- Penetrate Me, August 2022
- The Wound, June 2022
- In My Mother's House There Is Still God, April 2022
- A Mean, Feline Person, February 2022
- Do I Want to Be A Mother?, October 2021
- Cherubim, May 2021
- Black Narcissus, January 2021

Chicago Reader

- With E, Noa Micaela Fields playfully disregards convention, 2025

A Great Gay Book: Stories of Growth, Belonging & Other Queer Possibilities

- The Wound, May 2024

CLOWNS: An anthology from Dopamine Books

- Gazelle, 2025

Sissy Anarchy

- Pissing Contract, 2026

Skin, and Under: Evolving Young Machos

- Out of Season, 2025

Emerge: SAIC' Journal of Arts Administration and Policy

- Death to the Imperial Museum, April 2021

Catapult

- Buying My Girlhood, August 2022

Chicago Gallery News

- Marcela Torres Wants Us to Experience Violence, May 2020
- Art is... Jamillah Hinson: Outside the Boundaries of Self-Taught Art, January 2020
- Art is... Jordyn Belli, May 2019
- Art is... The Bittersweet, March 2019
- Art is... Graham Feyl, July 2018
- Ai Wei Wei: Trace in Chicago, May 2018
- Chicago gets its own Rushmore, December 2017